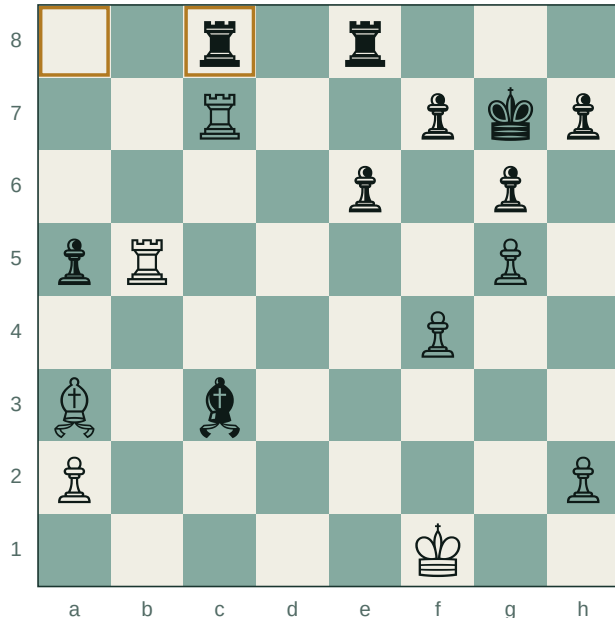


Attraction tactics: White, move 29

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 28...Rac8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

29. Rxc3 Rxc3 30. Bb2 Kf8 31. Bxc3

29.Rxc3 The rook captures the bishop on c3. Recorded reply: **29...Rxc3**.

30.Bb2 The bishop moves from a3 to b2. Recorded reply: **30...Kf8**.

31.Bxc3 The bishop captures the rook on c3.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on g7. Absolute pin: pawn on f7.